Ford Motor Company

A.R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

September 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Owner Notification Program 00B56: Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Front Stabilizer Bar Replacement

OASIS : Yes
OWNER LIST: Yes
PARTS RETURN: No
PROGRAM TERMS: This program will be in effect until September 30, 2001, regardless of mileage.

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 Model Year Escape vehicles built at the Kansas City Assembly Plant from January 31, 2000 through July 26, 2000.

REASON FOR PROGRAM

Certain affected vehicles were built with a front stabilizer bar that may have a high stress concentration and corrosion near the right hand attachment clamp. At the point of high stress, the powder coat paint may peel off, exposing the metal surface. With the powder coat paint protection absent, the stabilizer bar may rust at this location. The stabilizer bar is weakened due to corrosion and may eventually fracture. The potential for a fracture is most likely to occur at high mileage, during significant off-road use, and/or at a point in the vehicle's life outside of the warranty period. This action is being taken to ensure our customer's satisfaction and confidence with their 2001 model year Escape.

EFFECT ON VEHICLE OPERATION

Should a stabilizer bar fracture occur, the driver will notice an audible clunk or rattle under the vehicle. This condition may increase body roll while going into corners and reduce body roll while driving over large bumps. Under normal driving conditions on public roads, there is no unusual vehicle behavior during acceleration, braking, low or high-speed lane changes. A fractured stabilizer does not interfere with any safety related components, i.e. brakes, brake calipers, brake lines, tires / wheels, or other suspension components.

SERVICE ACTION

Dealers are directed to replace the vehicle's front stabilizer bar with a newly designed stabilizer bar with improved powder coat and corrosion resistance characteristics to correct this condition.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information: 1-800-423-8851
Other Program Questions: 1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

OWNER NOTIFICATION PROGRAM: 00B56
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Front Stabilizer Bar Replacement

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this program.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on the enclosed list and other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

Program Code:	00B56
Misc. Expense:	REFUND
Misc. Expense:	ADMIN
Misc. Expense:	0.2 Hr.

Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are not approved for this Owner Notification Program 00B56.

OWNER NOTIFICATION PROGRAM: 00B56
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Front Stabilizer Bar Replacement

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Replace Front Stabilizer Bar	00B56B	0.6 Hours

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621). Parts will be shipped Priority Next Day delivery.

Part Number	Quantity per Repair	Description
YL8Z-5482-AB	1	Bar, Front Stabilizer

NOTE: Removed parts must be mutilated and properly scrapped to prevent their use on another vehicle.

ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50176 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

October 2000

Owner Notification Program: 00B56

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

Ford Motor Company is providing a no-charge service, Program Number 00B56, to owners of certain 2001 model year Escape vehicles.

Reason For This Program…

Certain affected vehicles were built with a front stabilizer bar that may have a high stress concentration and corrosion near the right hand attachment clamp. At the point of high stress, the powder coat paint may peel off, exposing the metal surface. With the powder coat paint protection absent, the stabilizer bar may rust at this location. The stabilizer bar is weakened due to corrosion and may eventually fracture. The potential for a fracture is most likely to occur at high mileage, during significant off-road use, and/or at a point in the vehicle's life outside of the warranty period. This action is being taken to ensure our customer's satisfaction and confidence with their 2001 model year Escape.

Effect On Vehicle Operation…

Should a stabilizer bar fracture occur, the driver will notice an audible clunk or rattle under the vehicle. This condition may increase body roll while going into corners and reduce body roll while driving over large bumps. Under normal driving conditions on public roads, there is no unusual vehicle behavior during acceleration, braking, low or high-speed lane changes. A fractured stabilizer does not interfere with any safety related components, i.e. brakes, brake calipers, brake lines, tires / wheels, or other suspension components.

What *Ford Motor Company* and your dealer will do…

The vehicle's stabilizer bar will be replaced with a new stabilizer bar with improved powder coat and corrosion resistance characteristics.

This program will be in effect until September 30, 2001, regardless of mileage.

What we are asking you to do…

Call your dealer without delay. Provide the dealer with your Vehicle Identification Number (located at the beginning of this letter). Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Owner Notification Program 00B56.

If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

How long will it take…

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time. Please call your dealer for a service date.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)
Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)
Monday - Friday: 8:00 AM –11:00 PM
Saturday: 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to internet inquiries is three business days.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide Ford dealer network, we are here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Again, we are sorry for the inconvenience. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs